

Jiayu Zhao

Stanford Graduate School of Business

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APPOINTMENT	Assistant Professor Graduate School of Business Stanford University, Palo Alto, CA Job duties: Responsible for teaching core MBA courses in operations management and related areas, advising and mentoring students, and developing course materials for graduate business education. Conduct scholarly research on service platform operations, marketplace designs, and contribute to academic service within the Graduate School of Business.	July 2026 - Present
EDUCATION	Massachusetts Institute of Technology (MIT) , Cambridge, MA Ph.D. in Operations Research GPA: 5.0/5.0 Advisor: Daniel Freund Relevant coursework: operations management, inventory and logistics Columbia University , New York, NY B.S. in Operations Research Summa Cum Laude Relevant coursework: supply chain management, game theory, finance	2020 - 2025 2016 - 2020
RESEARCH INTERESTS	My research studies how service platforms can use market design and operational policies to improve efficiency. I use perspectives from revenue management, marketplace design, and operations management to study how platforms can improve matching outcomes, service reliability, and resource utilization. In tackling these challenges, I apply tools from game theory and stochastic decision-making to transportation, e-commerce, and other platform applications.	
PUBLICATIONS AND PREPRINTS	“<i>The Value of a Little Flexibility in Stable Matching</i>,” with Daniel Freund and Sébastien Martin. Available at SSRN 6208698, 2026. • This paper studies how limited flexibility in assignment choices can improve matching outcomes in service and marketplace settings. • Accepted at <i>27th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC’26)</i> “<i>Two-sided Flexibility in Platforms</i>,” with Daniel Freund and Sébastien Martin. Major Revision at <i>Operations Research</i>, 2026. Available at Arxiv 2404.04709. • This paper studies how platforms can balance customer-side and service-provider-side flexibility to improve marketplace efficiency and service quality. • MIT ORC Best Student Paper Award, 2024 “<i>On the Power of Delayed Flexibility: Balls, Bins, and a Few Opaque Promotions</i>,” with Daniel Freund and Chamsi Hssaine. Major Revision at <i>Operations Research</i>, 2026. Available at Arxiv 2306.01968. • This paper provides a novel way for online merchants to apply opaque promotions and reduce inventory costs. “<i>On the Supply of Autonomous Vehicles in Platforms</i>,” with Daniel Freund and Ilan Lobel. 2025. <i>Manufacturing & Service Operations Management</i> 28(2):496-516. • This work studies a supply chain model in which a hybrid workforce competes for utilization in service platforms. • Accepted at <i>25th ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC’24)</i> • Accepted for presentation at 2024 MSOM Supply Chain Management SIG “<i>Overbooking with Bounded Loss</i>,” with Daniel Freund. 2022. <i>Mathematics of Operations Research</i> 48(3): 1344-1363.	

- This paper proposes a decision-making policy with provable guarantee to the overbooking problem in airline and hotel industry.
- Accepted at *22nd ACM Conference on Economics and Computation (EC'21)*

EXPERIENCES **Google**, Mountain View, CA 2025 - 2026

Postdoctoral Researcher at Marketplace and Supply Optimization Team

- Worked on ride-hailing operational planning to improve rider service levels, vehicle utilization, and marketplace reliability.

Uber Technologies, Inc., San Francisco, CA Summer 2023 & 2024

Applied Scientist Intern at Uber Eats Eater Realtime Pricing (ERTP) Team

- Supported Uber Eats pricing and incentive programs; helped evaluate marketplace policies that improve order reliability, delivery-partner participation, and service quality during busy periods.

TEACHING **MIT**, Cambridge, MA

TA for *15.761 Operations Management* (MBA)

Spring 2022, 2023, 2024

TA for *15.S25 Experience in Operations Research* (PhD)

Summer 2022

- Held recitation sessions and prepared materials on pricing, contracting, inventory management, and operations strategy.

Columbia University, New York, NY

TA for *Ordinary Differential Equations* (Undergrad)

Fall 2018

TA for *IEOR E3658 Probability* (Undergrad)

Fall 2018

- Graded course materials, held office hours, drafted homework solutions, and administered course logistics.

**SELECTED
TALKS**

“The Value of a Little Flexibility in Stable Matching”

- INFORMS APS Conference, Jul 2025, Atlanta

“On the Power of Delayed Flexibility: Balls, Bins, and a Few Opaque Promotions”

- Marketplace Innovation Workshop, May 2025, Virtual

“Two-sided Flexibility in Platforms”

- UC Berkeley eMERGE Seminar Series, Mar 2026, Berkeley
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Oct 2025, Atlanta
- INFORMS APS Conference, Jul 2025, Atlanta
- University of British Columbia, Imperial College, London Business School, University College London, National University of Singapore, New York University, University of Toronto, Duke University, Stanford University, Columbia University
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Oct 2024, Seattle
- Inaugural OM Rookiepalooza at Kellogg, Oct 2024, Evanston
- MIT ORC Fall Seminar Series, Nov 2024, Cambridge
- RMP Conference, Jul 2024, Los Angeles
- MSOM Conference, Jul 2024, Minneapolis
- Marketplace Innovation Workshop, May 2024, Virtual
- MIT LIDS Student Conference, Feb 2024, Cambridge
- Xi'an Jiaotong University, Jan 2024, Xi'an, China
- Shanghai University of Finance and Economics, Dec 2023, Shanghai, China

“On the Supply of Autonomous Vehicles in Platforms”

- Guest lecture for *INDENG 150: Production Systems* and *INDENG 250: Production and Logistics Models*, Nov 2025, Berkeley
- MIT Operations Management Seminar, Oct 2024, Cambridge
- MSOM Conference Supply Chain Management SIG, Jun 2024, Minneapolis

- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Oct 2023, Phoenix
- Cornell Young Researchers Workshop, Oct 2023, Ithaca
- MSOM Conference, Jun 2023, Montreal, Canada
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Oct 2022, Indianapolis
- Marketplace Innovation Workshop, May 2023, Virtual

“Overbooking with Bounded Loss”

- EC’21, Jul 2021, Virtual
- INFORMS Annual Meeting, Oct 2021, Virtual
- ORC Student Seminar, Apr 2022, Cambridge

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES	Reviewer for <i>Management Science, Operations Research, Manufacturing & Service Operations Management</i>	2025 - Present
	Reviewer for the ACM STOC, ACM EC, and the MSOM Conference	2024 - 2025
	MIT ORC Seminar Series student coordinator	Fall 2023
	MIT Operations Management Seminar student co-organizer	2021 - 2023
HONORS AND AWARDS	Dan & Eva Roos Thesis Award	2025
	Recognition for outstanding doctoral thesis work at MIT.	
	MIT ORC Best Student Paper Award	2024
	Recognition for a student research paper at MIT Operations Research Center.	
	The Sebastian B. Littauer Award, Columbia University	2020
	Honor from the Columbia University for outstanding promise of scholarly achievement.	
	The Dean’s List, Columbia University	2016 - 2020
	Recognition of academic excellence at Columbia University.	
	C.P. Davis Scholar, Columbia University	2016
	Recognition by Columbia University for intellectual pursuits, extracurricular achievements, and promise for future growth and exploration.	